

DODGE · FOUR-WHEEL DRIVE · SINCE 1946

POWER WAGON

The army truck the boys wrote home about. Brought back for the farm, and still working eighty years later.

WANT THE WHOLE STORY?
SCAN TO READ
the full history on your phone



A Dodge WC command car pressing through a shattered town. The wartime truck that earned the legend, and the ancestor of every Power Wagon.

01 BORN IN WAR

When America went to war, Dodge stopped building for civilians and turned out the WC series of light military trucks. The three-quarter-ton weapons carrier earned a reputation as the truck that would go anywhere and never quit.

02 THE BOYS WROTE HOME

Many of those soldiers were farm boys. They came home wanting the truck that had carried them through the war and wrote to Dodge asking where a civilian could buy one. Dodge answered.

03 THE FIRST 4×4 YOU COULD BUY

In 1946 Dodge put the proven military running gear under a civilian cab and called it the Power Wagon. It was the first four-wheel-drive truck an ordinary buyer could drive off a dealer lot from a major manufacturer.

05 IT WOULDN'T RETIRE

American sales ended in 1968, but the trucks lived on. Armies and farmers ran them for decades, from rural France to the Philippines, and Israel kept building its own version into the 1980s.

04 A POWER PLANT ON WHEELS

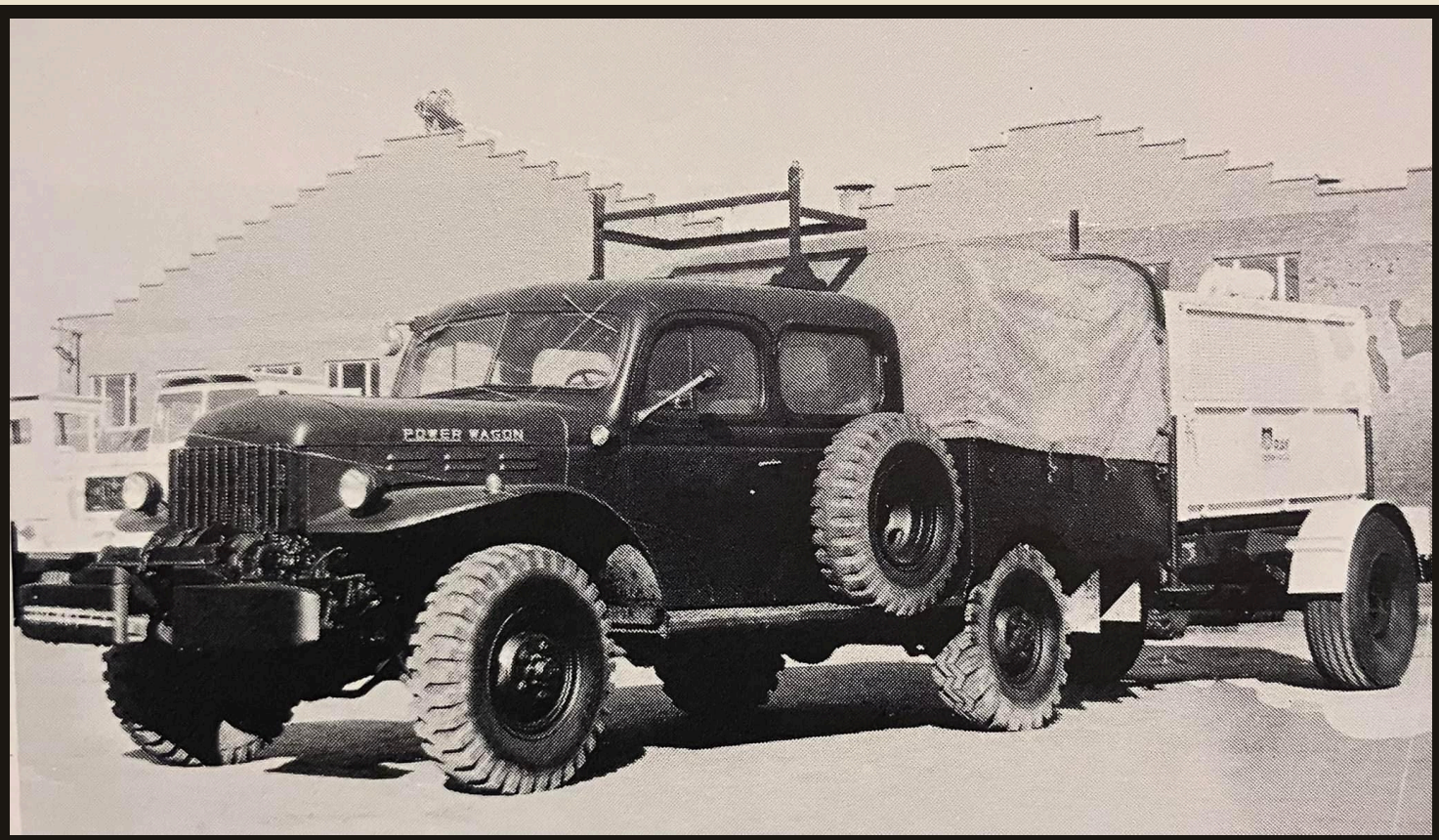
Dodge sold it as a truck, a tractor, and a portable power plant in one. With power take-off at the front, center, and rear, it could run a well rig, a saw, a generator, or a pump anywhere you could drive it.

06 THE NAME COMES BACK

Ram revived the Power Wagon in 2005 as the factory off-road 2500 and marked its 75th anniversary in 2021. The idea held from 1946: serious capability built in at the factory, not bolted on later.

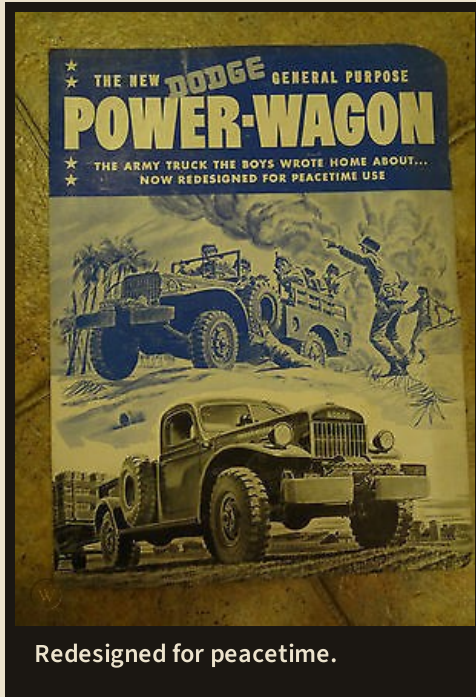


Discing a field with a hound riding shotgun. Truck, tractor, and power plant in one.



Bodied up for utility crews. A platform as much as a truck.

FROM THE ARCHIVE



Redesigned for peacetime.



Power for farms.



"The 4×4 that's different."



"America's greatest farm truck."

SOLD NOT AS A TRUCK, BUT AS A POWER PLANT YOU COULD DRIVE STRAIGHT TO THE WORK.

FAST FACTS

INTRODUCED
1946 WDX

DRIVE
First civilian 4×4

EXPORT BUILD
into 1978

ENGINE
230 cu in six ~94 hp

US PRODUCTION
1946 – 1968

POWER TAKE-OFF
front · ctr · rear

DID YOU KNOW

- ★ The Philippine army ran its wartime Dodges into the 1980s, and Israel built its own into the same decade.
- ★ The crew cab began as coachbuilt trucks for rail and utility crews, before any factory offered one.
- ★ It was the first mass-produced 4×4 from a major automaker. Earlier four-wheel-drive trucks were military or aftermarket conversions.



AND THIS ONE IS MINE

IS IT OLD OR NEW? YES.

A flat-fender Power Wagon body on a **2022 Ram Power Wagon** chassis with the **6.4 Hemi V8**. Built over two and a half years by **Tilsdale Coachworks** of Winslow, Indiana, finished by **Desert Power Wagon** in North Carolina.

EIGHTY YEARS OF SERVICE

1940

WC series goes to war

1946

Power Wagon reaches the public

1957

Crew cabs enter the catalog

1968

US civilian sales end

1978

Last export builds

1980s

Still serving worldwide

2005

The name returns on the Ram

2021

75th anniversary edition

NOW

This truck, carrying the story